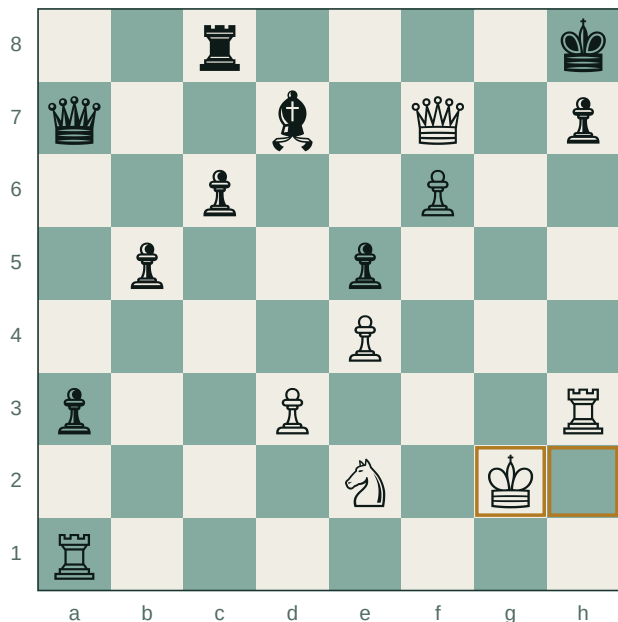


Discovered attacks: Black, move 38

Discovered attacks

Black to move



Previous move: 38.Kxg2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

38...Bxh3+ 39. Kxh3 Qxf7

38...Bxh3+ Check restricts White to 5 legal replies here. The changed line means the queen on a7 attacks the queen on f7. Recorded reply: **39.Kxh3**.

39...Qxf7 The queen captures the queen on f7.

At the end, nominal material is White 11 / Black 19 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +11. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +11:** the balance goes from -3 to +8. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Choose the blocker's destination carefully. An uncovered attack may fail if the opponent has a stronger check or can capture the slider.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Moving a blocker can uncover a rook, bishop, or queen attack. The moving piece may create a second threat, giving the defender too many problems at once.

HOW TO LOOK

Find a friendly piece between a slider and an enemy target, then inspect its forcing moves and captures.

The defending king is on g2. Geometrically undefended: queen on f7 and knight on e2. Check for tactical protection.